



THE WRITER'S SANCTUARY

Quick-Start Guide

Your writing practice, protected and organised.

Mirembé Muse — Where Transformation Has a Template

Welcome to Your Sanctuary

You write in your notes app at midnight. You have voice memos of poems you recorded at 2am before the words could escape. You have started novels, stopped them, restarted them. You have a gift that the world has not fully seen yet — not because the gift is not ready, but because nobody gave you the container to hold it.

This is your container.

The Writer's Sanctuary is the workspace built for writers who are serious about their craft and their legacy. A place where your drafts live alongside your inspiration. Where your submission tracker sits next to your character notes. Where your writing practice is treated like the serious creative work it is — not a hobby you squeeze in between everything else.

Writing is not just art. It is a career. It is a legacy. And African writers — our voices, our languages, our stories — are some of the most powerful and most underrepresented in the world. Writing in this sanctuary is an act of resistance. Of preservation. Of power.

Your story deserves to exist. Let this space help you tell it.

What's Inside Your Sanctuary

-  **Writing Projects** — every manuscript, collection, essay, and piece tracked from first word to final draft
-  **Writing Sessions** — log every session, your word count, mood, and what broke through
-  **Idea Vault** — capture every story seed, essay concept, and character spark before it vanishes
-  **Submission Tracker** — manage every submission from draft to response to payment
-  **Reading List & Research** — track what you read, what you learn, and how it feeds your writing
-  **Writing Habits** — the weekly practices that keep your creative life alive



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Before You Begin

You'll need the following to get started:

- A free or paid Notion account (notion.so)
- The template link from your Mirembé Muse purchase confirmation email
- 15–30 minutes of uninterrupted time for setup
- A list of your current writing projects, any pending submissions, and ideas waiting to be developed

⚡ PRO TIP — BEST ON DESKTOP FIRST Set up your sanctuary on a desktop or laptop before switching to mobile. Notion's mobile app works beautifully once configured, but first-time setup is smoother on a larger screen.

YOUR NOTION LINK: https://shard-purchase-279.notion.site/THE-WRITER-S-SANCTUARY-2f41f72e5a638090bdfc077c606f3a4?source=copy_link

Getting Started — Step by Step

1. **Duplicate the template into your Notion workspace** Click the link in your confirmation email.

https://shard-purchase-279.notion.site/THE-WRITER-S-SANCTUARY-2f41f72e5a638090bdfc077c606f3a4?source=copy_link

In Notion, click 'Duplicate' in the top right corner. Choose your workspace. All 6 databases will be copied into your account immediately.

2. **Read the Welcome page first** Open 'Welcome — READ THIS FIRST' inside the template. It is a short message from the founder — a self-published author and poet — written directly for writers. Read it before doing anything else.

3. **Add your current writing projects** Open Writing Projects. Click '+ New' for each piece of work you are currently writing or planning. Fill in the Title, Type (Novel / Poetry Collection / Short Story / Essay, etc.), Genre, Status, Word Count Goal, Current Word Count, and Priority. Add everything — works in progress, projects on hold, and pieces in editing. This database is your entire writing life in one view.



4. Log your first writing session After your next writing session, open Writing Sessions. Create an entry with the date, project linked, words written, session duration, mood, and a short note on what happened. This is your creative training log — every session is worth recording.

5. Fill the Idea Vault Open Idea Vault. Add every idea currently living in your notes app, voice memos, or loose notebooks. Give each idea a Type, Genre, Status, and a One-Line Pitch. Empty the idea clutter out of your head and into the system — where it can be developed, not forgotten.

6. Load your active submissions Open Submission Tracker. Add every piece you currently have submitted or are preparing to submit. Fill in the Publication/Client, Project Submitted, Submission Date, Response Deadline, Type, and Rights Offered. If you have received responses, log those too.

7. Start your Reading List & Research Open Reading List & Research. Add the books you are currently reading and any you have recently finished. Link each one to a related Writing Project. Fill in your Key Takeaways and Craft Notes — this is your personal literary education record.

8. Set up your Writing Habits Open Writing Habits. Review the pre-loaded habits and affirmations. Adjust them to match your actual writing practice. Set your weekly word count goal and begin tracking your daily and weekly output.

9. Bookmark your Sanctuary Pin the main Writer's Sanctuary page in your Notion sidebar. This is where you come every time you sit down to write.

Your 6 Modules — What Each One Does

Writing Projects

Every writing project, from first word to final submission — your complete creative portfolio

Key fields: Project Title, Type, Genre, Status, Priority, Word Count Goal, Current Word Count, % Complete, Start Date, Target Date, Deadline, Publication Target, Publisher / Platform, Revenue, Notes

Writing Sessions

Your creative training log — every session recorded, reflected on, and counted

Key fields: Title, Date, Project, Session Type, Session Duration (mins), Words Written, Focus Score (1–5), Mood (1–5), Mood Before, Mood After, Location, Daily Affirmation Used, Wins, Session Notes

Idea Vault

Every story seed, concept, and creative spark — captured, developed, and ready when you are

Key fields: Title, Idea, Type, Genre / Category, Status, Priority, One-Line Pitch, Full Description, Inspiration Source, Development Notes, Research Needed, Date Captured, Connected Projects, Related To

Submission Tracker

Every submission managed from draft to response – your publishing pipeline

Key fields: Project Title, Publication / Agent, Type, Submission Date, Response Deadline, Status, Word Count Submitted, Rights Offered, Submission Fee (R), Payment Expected, Payment Received, Contact Person, Submission Guidelines, Follow-Up Date, Response Received, Response Notes, Notes

Reading List & Research

Books read, research gathered, craft insights captured – your literary education database

Key fields: Book Title, Author, Type, Genre, Status, Rating (1–5), Date Started, Date Finished, Related Project, Key Themes, Craft Notes / Insights, Key Takeaways, Quotes, Source

Writing Habits

The weekly writing practice that keeps the work moving – tracked, reflected on, sustained

Key fields: Habit (Affirmation), Frequency, Week, Weekly Goal Met?, Weekly Word Count, Weekly Sessions, Avg Words/Session, Streak, Monday through Sunday word counts, Weekly Reflection, Why This Matters

Customising Your Sanctuary

Changing Status Labels

Click any status tag (like  Drafting or  Editing) and select 'Edit option' to rename or recolour it. Adjust to reflect your own creative process stages.

Adding Your Own Project Types

The Type field in Writing Projects is fully customisable. Add Memoir, Screenplay, Podcast Script, Chapbook, Newsletter, Academic Paper – whatever forms your writing takes.

Creating Custom Views

Each database supports Table, Board (Kanban), Calendar, Gallery, and Timeline views. Try a Board view of Writing Projects grouped by Status to see your entire pipeline at a glance. Try a Calendar view of Writing Sessions to see your output pattern across the month.

Filtering for Focus

Filter Writing Projects by Status = In Progress to see only what you are actively working on. Filter Submission Tracker by Status = Pending to see everything awaiting a response. Filter Idea Vault by Status = Developed and Priority = High to find your next project.



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Your Daily & Weekly Writing Workflow

When	Action
Before every writing session	Open Writing Sessions. Create a new entry with your project, planned duration, and today's affirmation. Set your session intention.
After every writing session	Complete the session entry. Log words written, mood, focus score, and at least one win — no matter how small.
When an idea comes	Open Idea Vault immediately. Log the Title, Type, and One-Line Pitch. Develop it later. Capture it now.
When you finish a draft	Update Writing Projects status to Editing or Submitted. Log completion in Notes. Move the piece to Submission Tracker when it's ready to go out.
When you submit	Create a Submission Tracker entry immediately. Set the Response Deadline and a Follow-Up Date. You should never wonder whether you have followed up or not.
When you finish a book	Update Reading List & Research to Complete. Write your Craft Notes — what did this book teach you about writing? Link it to the project it will influence.
Weekly (Sunday)	Review Writing Habits — log your week's word count and sessions. Update Writing Projects progress %. Check Submission Tracker for any follow-ups due.

Tips for Getting the Most Out of Your Sanctuary

- Log every session, even the bad ones. A 200-word session on a hard day is still a session. The habit of showing up is more valuable than any single word count.
- Write your One-Line Pitch in Idea Vault for every idea you add. The discipline of distilling an idea to one sentence reveals whether it is truly ready to develop — or still too vague.
- Use the Wins field in Writing Sessions even when the session felt like a failure. Something happened — a line you are proud of, a block you pushed through, a connection you made. Find it and name it.
- The Craft Notes / Insights field in Reading List & Research is where your reading becomes your education. Do not read passively — read like a writer and record what you learn.
- Follow up on every submission. Log your Follow-Up Date in Submission Tracker and stick to it. Most publications expect follow-ups. Silence is not always a rejection.
- Link your Reading List entries to Writing Projects. When you finish a book that influences a project, the connection is recorded — and when you return to that project months later, you remember why you read it.
- The affirmations in Writing Habits are not decoration. Read your daily affirmation before you open your document. It takes 10 seconds and it changes the quality of what follows.





🌟 A Note from Nanda

"Writing is not just art. It is a career. It is a legacy.

African writers — our voices, our languages, our stories — are some of the most powerful and most underrepresented in the world. That is not a coincidence. It is a system that was designed to silence us.

Writing in this sanctuary is an act of resistance. Of preservation. Of power.

Your story deserves to exist. Your drafts deserve a home. Your submissions deserve to be tracked. Your reading deserves to feed your craft.

This system holds all of it. Now you just have to show up and write."

— **Nandawula Regine Kabali-Kagwa, Founder, Mirembé Muse**

Self-Published Author & Poet

Support & Community

🖥️ **Technical Support** Email us with a screenshot and description of any issue. We won't rest until it's working perfectly for you.

👑 **Muse Collective Community** Join the community of African writers, creators, and builders using Mirembé Muse systems to build extraordinary things.

🌿 *Mirembé Muse — Where Transformation Has a Template*

Write with intention. Submit with courage. Build your literary legacy.



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